- That material witnesses, including the SP (City) who had conducted the enquiry and other officers related with it and in the know of vital facts, were not examined in the enquiry.

- That no inspection of the police station after 1985 recorded the files to be missing and that the officers under enquiry who were proposed to be suspended had no malafide intentions to tamper with or destroy the records since they were in charge of the same areas in subsequent years.

- That the report of the expert was not from a government source – it was from a private expert who had (to the best of her knowledge) been compulsorily 'retired' from his service.

- That the special report was a contemporaneous record and was not commented upon by the enquiry report when seen by the EO.

- That the cases being untraced, the case files were expected to be destroyed after five years. These ought to have been considered destroyed in 1995.

- That there appeared to be no malafide intention as both files under enquiry were untraced, and missing or tampering of the files benefited or harmed nobody.

- That the enquiry report was incomplete and any conclusion drawn from there would lead to a miscarriage of justice.

Kiran pointed out that the record of the officers under suspension had been examined. They were highly decorated and had decades of distinguished service. The officers were worthy to professionally hold sensitive charges for a long period of time.

But all this was of no avail.

Her predecessor was not wrong. He had also made protests but no one had heard them. Kiran did the same, and this time people became aware of the goings-on, thanks to the media. The media reported both versions: Kiran's and the home secretary's. The 'indispensability factor' of the home secretary was nullified. People for the first time started to offer evidence of the home secretary malfunctioning as the de facto IG of Chandigarh and also of her interference in Chandigarh Police affairs, even in small matters. She had earlier denied any interference! She did not have any defence for this state of affairs, except to make counterallegations against Kiran.

Kiran, for her part, forcefully defended her police force and resisted any suspension of personnel. She clearly declared: 'I was an IG of the City Police to lead my force, to deliver quality service to the people, not to preside over their exploitation. I was not to be an onlooker but a change agent for the betterment of the police service.' But it appeared there were entrenched elements in the system that did not want Kiran to fulfil her objectives. They wanted the police to remain unprofessional and subservient to them. They wanted the police to carry out their diktats. Also, when it suited these elements, they expected the police to be available so that the latter could be castigated. According to Kiran, she 'was not there to be a witness. I was now duty-bound to check the decline in the morale of the police force; otherwise how do I expect them to work and take initiatives that the city expected of them'.

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